



United States
Attorney's Office
District of Connecticut



U.S. Attorney Vanessa Roberts Avery Announces Resignation

Monday, January 6, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of
Connecticut

New Haven – United States Attorney Vanessa Roberts Avery today announced that she will resign from the Office effective at 11:59 p.m. on January 17.

"It has been the honor of a lifetime to serve as United States Attorney, and I am profoundly appreciative of President Biden for trusting me to serve our nation and the people of Connecticut in this position," said Ms. Avery. "I have been especially honored to lead an office of extremely talented public servants who are dedicated to the highest standards of excellence and professionalism and committed to the cause of justice. Together, we have employed collaborative, data and intelligence-driven strategies to make our communities safer and ensure justice for all who live in our state. We have done the hard work of engaging the community alongside our local, state, and federal law enforcement partners, contributing to declining violent crime rates and opioid overdose deaths. I am confident that this Office will continue to make Connecticut a safe place to live, and have a positive impact in our communities."

Ms. Avery was appointed by President Biden after confirmation by the United States Senate and sworn in as the 54th U.S. Attorney for the District of Connecticut on May 9, 2022. Under Ms. Avery's leadership, the U.S. Attorney's Office prioritized the prosecution of crimes related to [gun](#) and [gang](#) violence, [firearms trafficking](#), [narcotics](#) and [counterfeit opioid pill](#) trafficking, [child exploitation](#), human trafficking and [smuggling](#), [financial frauds](#), [public corruption](#), [cybercrime](#), and [national security](#) issues. In addition, the Office's Civil Division has aggressively pursued health care fraud violators, achieved numerous disability rights settlements, and recovered millions of dollars through forfeiture actions. In Fiscal Year 2023, the Office [recovered more than \\$233 million in](#) criminal and civil actions, which ranked third in the nation among all U.S. Attorney's Offices.

As U.S. Attorney, Ms. Avery has stressed the Office's community engagement, particularly through its [HEAT](#) and [Fed-Up](#) programs, as a critical component to reducing drug addiction, overdose deaths, and violent criminal behavior. In addition, she has spearheaded civil rights and hate crimes prevention through United Against Hate presentations across Connecticut. United Against Hate has raised

community awareness about hate crimes, hate incidents, and discrimination, and is building bridges between law enforcement and community, ethnic, and religious groups, particularly those with members who have been reluctant to contact law enforcement for help.

Prior to her appointment as U.S. Attorney, Ms. Avery served as the Associate Attorney General and Chief of the Division of Enforcement and Public Protection at the Connecticut Office of the Attorney General. From 2014 to 2019, Ms. Avery was an Assistant U.S. Attorney in the Civil Division in this District, prosecuting a variety of complex civil fraud cases under the False Claims Act, asset forfeiture cases, environmental violations, civil rights matters, and defending Bivens and medical malpractice cases.

From 2006 to 2014, Ms. Avery was a litigation attorney at McCarter & English LLP, where she focused on business and financial litigation, intellectual property, trust and probate, and product liability cases. From 2003 to 2005, Ms. Avery was a Trial Attorney with the U.S. Department of Justice in the Commercial Litigation Branch of the Civil Division in Washington, D.C. From 1999 to 2003, she was an attorney in the Hartford Trial Group at Cummings & Lockwood LLC. Ms. Avery is a graduate of Yale University and the Georgetown University Law Center.

Marc H. Silverman, who has served as First Assistant U.S. Attorney since May 2024, will serve as Acting U.S. Attorney upon Ms. Avery's departure. Mr. Silverman joined the U.S. Attorney's Office in 2010. From 2014 to 2022, he served as Deputy Chief of the Office's Appellate Division, and from 2022 to May 2024, he was Chief of the Criminal Division. Mr. Silverman is a graduate of Yale University and Yale Law School.

Mr. Silverman will be the 55th U.S. Attorney for the District of Connecticut, an office that was established in 1789.

"The U.S. Attorney's Office is in excellent hands," said Ms. Avery. "Marc and the Office's superb supervisory team have the highest professional and ethical standards and, together with our federal, state, and local law enforcement partners will ensure that the administration of justice will seamlessly continue in our District."

The U.S. Attorney's Office is charged with enforcing federal criminal laws in Connecticut and representing the federal government in civil litigation. The Office is composed of approximately 68 Assistant U.S. Attorneys and approximately 54 staff members at offices in New Haven, Hartford, and Bridgeport.

Updated January 6, 2025

Topic

OFFICE AND PERSONNEL UPDATES

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September 8, 2025

PRESS RELEASE

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Attorney General Pamela Bondi has signed an order appointing David X. Sullivan, 65, of New Fairfield, as the Interim U.S. Attorney for the District of Connecticut. Mr. Sullivan was sworn...

May 12, 2025

PRESS RELEASE

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Acting U.S. Attorney Marc H. Silverman today announced that the District of Connecticut collected \$26,212,307 in criminal and civil actions in Fiscal Year 2024. Of this amount, approximately \$14,110,085 was...

February 5, 2025



District of Connecticut

Main Office:

